Simon McWhinnie

Senior PHP Developer

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Senior PHP developer with 15+ years of experience delivering complex web systems at scale. At Immediate Media for nearly 8 years, I have led three critical business projects, co-designed a micro-services architecture serving millions of readers, and held formal line management responsibility. I am looking to step into a lead or principal role where I can drive technical direction and help engineering teams deliver at their best.

EXPERIENCE

Immediate Media · Senior PHP Developer

Jun 2018 – Present

- Co-designed and delivered a Symfony micro-services architecture for BBC Good Food, simplifying a monolith WordPress service (2019–2022).
- Built and maintained the AWS SQS inter-service message queue layer, handling communication between services underpinning the new architecture.
- Contributed to the deprecation of the message queue service and its migration into a Webhooks solution.
- Designed and delivered a Customer Data Platform integration within a year — event-driven PHP services pushing data to email and CDP systems, and a Lambda/Serverless GDPR admin application with internal identity-controlled access.
- Key contributor to replacing the entire web and print subscription platform with a third-party provider in 9 months, on time and within budget.
- Built a business-wide API testing framework in JavaScript using Postman, improving confidence in service integrations across teams.
- Initiated the migration from AWS CodeBuild to GitHub Actions for automated testing — simplifying test setup, enabling shared reusable actions, and ensuring tests were run consistently across the codebase.
- Used Datadog as the primary observability platform for logging, monitoring and incident response.
- Delivered a TypeScript-based service, extending strong typing practices beyond the core PHP stack.
- Runs regular knowledge-sharing sessions and a PHP Community of Practice across the engineering team.
- Formal line management (2024–2025); ongoing responsibilities include architectural review, mentoring, and code quality.

Product and Tech Most Improved Developer (2019) · Most Innovative Developer, peer-voted (2024) · Team of Year & CEO Award (2025) · Leadership Behaviours Adaptive Award (2026)

Southbank Investment Research · Senior Developer

May 2017 – May 2018

- Redeployed the entire company website onto AWS infrastructure.
- Led development of a critical React-based member login area providing subscribers access to exclusive content, with fully integrated payment systems.

Earlier career

2010 – 2017

Informa · Ovum · Time Inc. UK · MoneyWeek

Progressed from Web Developer to Senior across digital publishing businesses. Led a company-wide Flash-to-JavaScript migration, introduced Git version control, built WordPress multisite solutions, and took on team management responsibilities.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES
PHP · Python · Rust · TypeScript

FRAMEWORKS & CMS
Symfony · WordPress · React · Composer · Twig

CLOUD & INFRASTRUCTURE
AWS (SQS, ECS, EC2, Lambda, Secrets Manager, CodeBuild, CodePipeline, S3, API Gateway) · Docker · Serverless · GitHub Actions · Jenkins · Linux · Datadog

DATA
MySQL · MongoDB · Redis · Elasticsearch

ARCHITECTURE
Micro-services · Event-driven · REST APIs · Message queues

TESTING & TOOLS
PHPUnit · Postman · Git · Agile

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Multimedia

Griffith University, Brisbane, Australia